Blanks, repeats and impossible values

Data engineering · Level 2 · Lesson 3



In this lesson you will

- Tell a blank from a zero; never guess.
- Find repeats and impossible values.
- Write a Python check for blanks and values out of range.

Key ideas

- A blank is not a zero.
- Impossible values need checking, not averaging.
- When something’s wrong, ask; don’t guess.

Spot the problems

1. Look (3 min): a rain table
2. Hunt (5 min): circle the problems
3. Decide (4 min): what to do
4. Compare (3 min): before and after

Keep the numbers small so the averages are quick to work out by hand.

Let's discuss

1. Why is a blank not the same as a zero?
2. When is a repeat not really a repeat?
3. Why check for blanks before checking the range?

Exit ticket

- Write one blank, one repeat and one impossible value, and what you’d do with each.